Brand Intelligence Generates On-Brand. Nothing Verifies It Stays On-Brand.

With Canva AI 2.0 making creation effortless, the gap between generating on-brand content and verifying it stays compliant is now the biggest friction point for teams.

PAIN POINTS

Human Edits Break What AI Builds

The moment a team member pastes an element, types a hex code, or swaps an image, Brand Intelligence has no mechanism to re-check compliance. The design drifts silently.

Approval Is a Manual Bottleneck

Reviewers visually inspect every element. No compliance score, no flags, no suggested fixes. Teams spend up to 15 hrs/week on brand-policing instead of strategic feedback.

Non-AI Content Has Zero Guardrails

Designs from scratch, customized templates, and uploaded assets bypass Brand Intelligence entirely. For many teams, this is the majority of output.

EVIDENCE

"Even with locked elements, users can still change colors or place unwanted elements on top."

- RightMarket Analysis

"The time saved by AI-generated design gets consumed by compliance review."

- Futurum Group, April 17, 2026

"Brand consistency depends on users. The platform provides tools to stay on brand, but doesn't enforce rules across teams."

- Prezent.ai Review, 2026

WHY NOW

AI has accelerated creation.
The next challenge is governance.

$500M
B2B ARR, growing 100% YoY

95%
of Fortune 500 use Canva

265M
monthly active users

Brand Guardian

AI Governance Inside the Editor

Brand Guardian ensures every design stays on-brand, consistent, and ready to publish

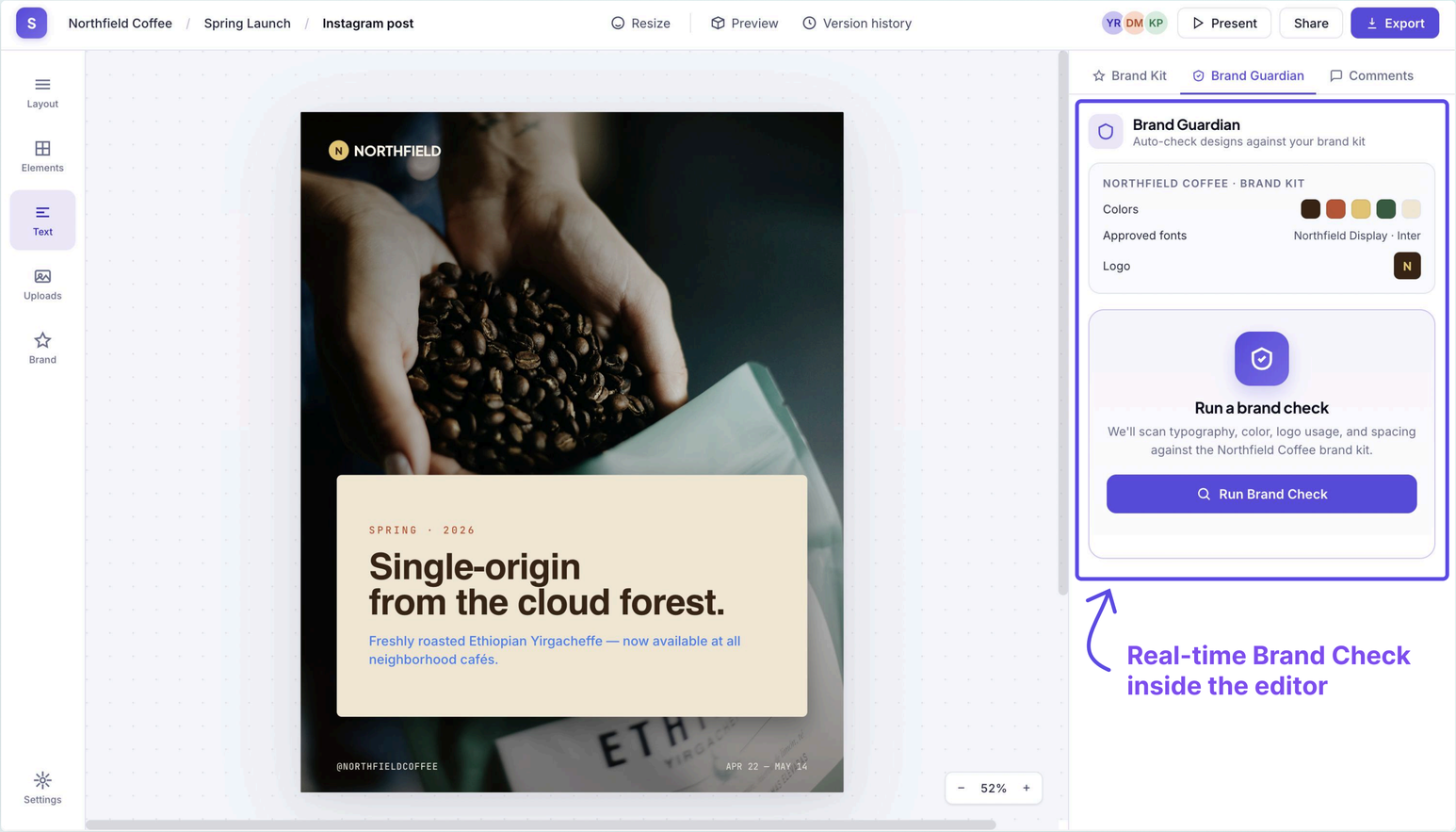
WHAT IT DOES

Detects Issues in Real-Time
Scans typography, color, logo usage, spacing, and tone against your Brand Kit.

Guides and Auto Fixes
Applies one-click or automatic fixes, including rewriting copy to match brand voice.

Enforces Before You Publish
Blocks publishing when designs don't meet brand standards

Scales Across Your Teams
Works across assets and campaigns so consistency holds at scale



Real-time Brand Check inside the editor

https://shreyas-30.github.io/brand-guardian/

THE IMPACT

Faster approvals. Fewer edits. Consistent output at scale.

30-50% estimated reduction in manual corrections

20-40% faster time to finalize

15-30% higher first-pass publish rate

Measuring what matters for governance that works

Five metrics to track adoption, accuracy, friction reducton, outcomes, and trust

LEADING

Activation Rate

60%+

of Biz/Enterprise teams enable Brand Guardian

PMF signal. If teams don't turn it on, nothing else matters. Track by team size cohort, larger teams should activate at higher rates.

LEADING

Fix Acceptance Rate

70%+

of suggested fixes accepted

Measures whether AI suggestions are accurate and useful, not just noisy. Low acceptance means the model needs retraining.

NORTH STAR

Approval Cycle Time

40%

reduction in submit → approved

The core value prop: approvers spend less time brand-policing because AI pre-screened. Directly measures friction reduction.

LAGGING

Off-Brand Publish Rate

50%

reduction in non-compliant publishes

The business outcome: fewer off-brand assets reaching customers. Requires establishing a baseline in the first 2 weeks of rollout.

GUARDRAIL

False Positive Rate

< 15%

of flags dismissed as incorrect

Alert fatigue is the #1 risk. Too many false positives and users disable the feature entirely.

Three Phases, Twelve Weeks

From rules-based MVP to AI-powered intelligence at scale

PHASE 1 · WEEKS 1 - 4

Rules-Based MVP

SCOPE
Typography + color compliance scan. Violation sidebar with one-click fixes.
Brand Score (0 - 100).

TEAMS
2 FE, 1 BE, 1 Designer

KEY RISK
Brand Kit data quality varies;
scan must be <3 seconds

MILESTONE
Internal dogfood with Canva marketing by Week 3

PHASE 1 · WEEKS 5 - 9

AI Analysis + Approvals

SCOPE
Design Model analysis for logos, layout, image style. Brand Score in approval workflow. Learn-from-overrides feedback loop.

TEAMS
+ 1 ML Eng, Approvals team, Research

KEY RISK
Model accuracy lower than rules; enterprise privacy concerns

MILESTONE
Closed beta with 20 Enterprise customers by Week 8

PHASE 1 · WEEKS 10 - 12

Intelligence + Scale

SCOPE
Brand Voice compliance. Compliance trend dashboard. Enforcement levels (advisory → block). External API.

TEAMS
Full team + Data Science, Trust & Safety, Sales

KEY RISK
Voice analysis is subjective;
feature complexity for small teams

MILESTONE
General Availability launch for all Business & Enterprise teams

How I Built This

THE WORKFLOW

Pain Point Discovery

Claude. ChatGPT. Canva. User Interview. Reddit

AI synthesized 10 themes from G2, Capterra, and forums. I validated by testing Canva AI 2.0 myself, interviewing a user, and reading r/canva threads.

Competitive Analysis

Web Research. Claude

Mapped Canva vs. Adobe Express, Figma Buzz, and Microsoft Designer on pricing, AI features, and brand governance.

Real-Time Adaptation

Canva Create 2026 Keynote

Watched the full keynote mid-exercise. Brand Intelligence launched, I reframed the pitch from "Canva has no brand AI" to "generate + verify = complete governance."

Solution, Deck & Prototype

Figma. Claude Code. Github

AI helped draft content. I chose the problem, framed the positioning, set metric targets, and built the prototype with Claude Code.

WHAT I KEPT VS. CHANGED

Kept from AI

- Pain point ranking framework (severity × frequency × AI-solvability)
- 5-metric structure with leading / lagging / guardrail types
- Deck structure and narrative flow

Changed from AI

- Problem framing after trying Canva AI 2.0 + talking to 1 user + forums
- Selected this problem over 4 others - brand compliance for distributed teams
- Refined metric targets based on realistic enterprise adoption patterns
- 3-phase, 12-week ship plan

Most Impactful AI Moment

While watching Canva Create 2026 live, I realized that newly launched Brand Intelligence solved half my pitch. But instead of pivoting completely, I reframed into a stronger complementary positioning for my deck.